DETECTIVE ONLY · CASE #1031

How the evidence adds up

Rule of the Bureau: a clue never says who did it. It says who **didn't**. Each station produces one fact; the squad checks it against the suspects' own statement forms and crosses off whoever doesn't match. Four stations, four suspects, four cross-offs. Whoever is left wasn't on the list.

1 · Do the station
Measure, fizz, decode, or wrap. Every kid has a job.

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2 · Open the clue
The sealed envelope states the fact in plain words.

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3 · Check the statements
Read the four forms on the wall (and the case file table).

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4 · Cross one off
Whoever doesn't match is cleared. Write "Clears:" in the log.

Clue	🏫 Principal	📖 Reading Specialist	📚 Librarian	🧹 Custodian	🍎 The Chief not on the list
👣 **1 · Evidence Lab** Footprint by the shelf: 26 cm = **size 9**. Who does NOT wear a 9?	✓ size 9	✓ size 9	✗ **size 7 · cleared**	✓ size 9	✓ size 9
👻 **2 · Ghostbuster Lab** Ghost words: SEEN IN HALL AT **2:15**. Now the time is known. Who was NOT in the building at 2:15?	✗ **off campus 1:00–3:00 · cleared**	✓ reading room, all afternoon	✓ shelving 2:00–2:30	✓ in the building, all afternoon	✓ classroom, all afternoon
📜 **3 · Cipher Room** Hidden P.S. on the note: "Snagged my **orange sweater** on the shelf." Who did NOT wear orange?	✓ orange sweater	✓ orange, Halloween week	✓ orange cardigan	✗ **gray · cleared**	✓ orange sweater
🧻 **4 · Mummy Witness** The witness: squeezed one, whispered "so satisfying." The thief **loves squishies**. Who does NOT love squishies?	✓ loves them ("just one")	✗ **doesn't get them · cleared**	✓ one on every cart	✓ loves them (records)	✓ "Fine. Love them."
After four clues	**Cleared by Clue 2**	**Cleared by Clue 4**	**Cleared by Clue 1**	**Cleared by Clue 3**	**Matches all four**

2:28 · How the Chief gets caught

1. A squad says "everyone's crossed off." The Detective: "Then your list is too short. Size 9, in the building at 2:15, orange sweater, loves squishies. Who else was in this building yesterday?"
2. The Detective produces the **fifth statement form**, the Chief's, "filled out for completeness," and pins it to the board.
3. The squad checks it line by line: size 9 ✓, classroom all afternoon ✓, orange sweater ✓, "Don't be ridiculous" crossed out, "Fine. Love them." ✓
4. Warrants name the Chief. Video 4 is her confession, and it tells them where the squishies are: "you'd need a very special light."

The breadcrumbs (for the kid who asks "how were we supposed to know?")

- The opening: "Chief Mrs. Driscoll has assured me she is not a suspect."
- After Video 1, the Chief's live flinch: "Candy. ...Mostly. Candy-adjacent."
- The Principal's slip: who told *him* they were squishies?
- The Librarian saw someone hugging something "like a puppy," which is exactly what the witness saw.
- The Librarian's whisper: "check their feet."

✓ matches the clue · ✗ doesn't match, cross them off